

VSA Prompt Packet - Microsoft 365 Copilot

Copy, paste, replace the [brackets]. Every prompt on this sheet works on the VSA tenant today.

The one rule that never fails: **attach the file**. July 2026.

Session A - Prompting & Copilot Chat

The framework: G C S E - Goal (the deliverable) / Context (who it's for) / Source (attach the file) / Expectations (format, length, tone).

1. Absorb a long document

Summarize the attached [policy/report] for [audience]: 5 bullets on what changed, plain language, include section numbers.

2. Brief leadership

Using the attached report, draft a one-page brief for [leader]: progress summary, top 3 risks with owners, decisions needed this week.

3. Tighten anything

Remove any sentence without a decision, a number, or an action.

4. Iterate - the four verbs (follow-ups, no re-attaching needed)

Rewrite this for [different audience]. / Reorganize as: summary, findings, risks, next steps. / Keep only the top 3 items by impact. / Cut it to half the length, keep all numbers.

5. Power move: let it interview you

Interview me one question at a time to build the best prompt for [task].

6. Power move: self-critique

Critique your answer and rewrite it better.

7. Borrow an expert voice

Act as a [range safety officer / contracts specialist / communications director]. Review the attached document and flag what your role would catch.

8. The skeptical executive

You are a skeptical executive reviewer. What three questions would you ask before approving this?

Tip: the Prompt Gallery (Create, in the Copilot app) has proven prompts by task and role - save your winners and share the team's.

Validate anything

9. Make it show its work

List your source for each claim in that answer - one line per claim.

10. Pin the claim to the page

Quote the exact sentence from the attached document that supports [claim].

11. Surface its doubt

What in this answer are you least confident about, and why?

Session B - Teams & Outlook

12. Thread archaeology (Outlook "Summary by Copilot", or paste the thread into Chat)

Summarize this thread: decisions made, who owes what, deadlines mentioned.

13. The reply pattern - confirm, commit, ask

Draft a reply confirming [X], committing to [Y] by [date], and asking who owns [Z]. Professional, under 150 words.

14. Coach your risky email (Outlook Coaching)

Review this draft for tone and clarity. My reader is [who]; I need them to [do what].

15. The commitments table

Who owes what, by when, in this thread? Table: person, item, deadline.

16. Grounded reply with receipts

Using the attached [agreement/policy], answer this question and cite the section: [question]

Personalize it - Copilot in YOUR voice

Once, 15 minutes: copy ~10 sent emails you're proud of, then -

17. Capture your voice

These are emails I wrote. Analyze my writing style and produce a reusable style guide: tone, sentence rhythm, structure habits, greetings and sign-offs. Then add a NEVER list: buzzwords and AI-sounding phrases that never appear in my writing (e.g. leverage, delve, synergy, "I hope this finds you well"). Be specific.

18. Draft as you

Using this style guide: [paste profile] - draft [the email you need]. Keep all facts; the voice is non-negotiable and nothing from the never list.

Save the profile to a Page named "My voice" (find it in Library). Refresh quarterly. The never list is what keeps drafts sounding like you instead of AI - be ruthless with it.

19. Meeting prep brief

Using the attached docs, build a one-page prep brief for my meeting with [who]: their obligations, our commitments, open items, 3 questions I should ask.

20. Timed agenda

Turn this brief into a [45]-minute agenda with time boxes; put open items first.

21. Follow-up email

Draft a follow-up email from these meeting notes: decisions, action items with owners, next meeting date. Brief and friendly.

Session C - PowerPoint & Word

22. Grounded draft (Word - reference your files)

Write a [brief/memo/summary] covering [topics] based on [reference files]. Include owners and dates.

23. Audience rewrite (select text first)

Rewrite this selection for [audience]: [tone], half the length, keep all numbers.

24. Interrogate a document

What does this document say about [topic]? Point me to the section.

25. Inherit a deck (PowerPoint)

Summarize this presentation in 5 bullets for someone presenting it tomorrow.

26. Fix a wall-of-words slide (select the text box)

Rewrite as max 6 words per bullet, keep all numbers.

27. Navigate a big deck

Which slides mention [topic]?

Evaluate anything - rubric first**28. Build the rubric (before reading options)**

From this specification, build a weighted evaluation rubric: 5-6 criteria, weights summing to 100, one line on what excellent looks like.

29. Score with receipts

Score each option against this rubric. Table: criterion, weight, score, weighted total. Cite your source per score.

30. Capture the dissent

Argue FOR the lowest scorer - steelman it in 5 bullets. Then draft the recommendation memo with a Dissent Considered section.

31. Contract obligations sweep

List every obligation on OUR side of this agreement, with section numbers and deadlines.

Session D - OneNote & Excel

Excel tip: format your data as a named table first (select data -> Insert -> Table). Copilot reasons far better over tables.

32. Formula from plain English

Write a formula for [calculation] using the [TableName] table. Handle [edge case, e.g. divide by zero].

33. Decode an inherited formula

Explain this formula like I'm not an Excel person: [paste formula]

34. Debug loop

This returned [error]. Fix it.

35. What-if framing

I want to model [scenario]. What columns and formulas should I add?

36. Notes into a safety net (OneNote - or attach the notes in Chat)

Extract every action item from these notes as a table: action, owner, deadline. Flag anything with no owner.

37. Notes for the status call

Summarize these notes in 5 bullets for a status call - decisions first.

38. Minutes you can send

Rewrite these notes as professional meeting minutes I can send to [who].

Keep a Page named "My prompts" - every prompt that works goes in; share the winners with your team.

Your first week

Mon: summarize a thread (#12) / Tue: draft one section (#22) / Wed: ask one formula (#32) / Thu: refine one notes page (#36) / Fri: share a win with your team.

Remember: Copilot drafts, you decide. Verify numbers and names against the source before anything leaves you.

Responsible AI - your daily checklist

Review before you share - every output is a first draft; check accuracy, tone, and fit. / **Protect sensitive data** - nothing classified, regulated, or personal in a prompt without authorization. / **Watch for bias** - scrutinize outputs about people, decisions, or recommendations. / **Verify the receipts** - click a citation before a number leaves you. / **Disclose when appropriate** - know your organization's policy on AI-assisted work.

Which app for which job

You need to...	Go to
Absorb, draft, or brief from documents	Copilot Chat (attach the file)
Triage threads, draft and coach replies	Outlook
Draft and rewrite documents, interrogate long files	Word
Summarize, tighten, and navigate decks	PowerPoint
Formulas, explanations, what-ifs	Excel
Turn notes into actions and minutes	OneNote
Keep a great answer	Send it to a Page (Library)

Keep learning

Microsoft Learn Copilot paths: learn.microsoft.com/training (search "Microsoft 365 Copilot") / Copilot Adoption Hub: adoption.microsoft.com/copilot / Your practice files and this packet: github.com/scottrhay/vsacopilot